COURSE

AQA GCSE Business (8132)

Motivating and retaining employees

3.4 Human resources · 3.4.3 Motivating employees

Revision for 3.4 Human resources: each firm works it out on its own deals.

Class	Topic
AQA GCSE Business (8132)	**Motivating and retaining employees**

THE LESSON

Setup					3 min
Round 1					Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 1 **Pay per car sold**	TASK 2 **Non-financial ways**		
Round 2					Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 3 **Rank pay this month**	TASK 4 **Pay with commission**	**B2B deal**	
Round 3					Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 5 **Pay rise or variety**	TASK 6 **Commission effects**	**B2B deal**	
Final questions					3 min

Fits a 30-minute lesson setting; longer settings add more deals.

Each step

Firm decisions	Each role makes its decision on its own page.
Deals	Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm.
Topic task	The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree.
B2B deal	One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm.
Final questions	Each pupil answers six questions.

Firm decisions

CEO	**Staff**	Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit.
	Sabotage FROM ROUND 2	Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it.
Sales & Marketing	**Marketing**	Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales.
Finance	**Capital & Loans**	Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest.
	Investments FROM ROUND 2	Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall.
Operations	**Seasonal stock**	Order the season's cars in advance.

B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

Task 1

ROUND 1

Your sales staff earn the same whatever they sell. Sales are flat.

Which financial method pays for each car sold?

PICK ONE

- ○ A higher salary
- ○ A yearly bonus
- ✔ **Commission**
- ○ Fringe benefits

Why: Commission is a share of each sale, so pay follows selling.

Task 2

ROUND 1

You cannot afford pay rises this year.

Which two are non-financial ways to motivate?

PICK TWO

- ○ A bonus for hitting targets
- ○ A staff discount on cars
- ○ Commission on each sale
- ✔ **More responsibility at work**
- ✔ **Praise and awards for good work**

Why: Praise and responsibility cost little; the other three are money or benefits.

Task 3

ROUND 2

A salesperson sells 7 cars worth £60,000 this month. Three ways to pay her.

Order by pay this month, highest first?

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **£1,800 plus 1% of sales**
2. **£2,300 salary, no commission**
3. **£1,200 plus £150 a car**

Why: £2,400, £2,300 and £2,250.

Task 4

ROUND 2

Basic pay plus commission on sales.

Her pay this month?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Basic pay this month	**£1,800**
Her car sales this month	**£85,000**
Commission on her sales	**1%**

METHOD

Pay = basic pay + commission × her sales

£1,800 + 1% × £85,000 = £2,650

Why: Commission rises with each sale, so her pay follows her selling.

Task 5

ROUND 3

Staff say their pay is fair, but the work is the same every day.

Which change should you make, and why?

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ○ A 3% pay rise for all
- ✔ **More varied, responsible work**

Why: Pay is not the problem; varied work with responsibility tackles dull jobs.

Task 6

ROUND 3

You move sales staff to commission only. Sales rise, but complaints from buyers double.

What best explains this?

PICK ONE

- ○ Staff have less work to do
- ○ Staff now earn less each month
- ✔ **Staff push buyers to buy fast**
- ○ The firm has fewer staff

Why: Pay now depends on each sale, so some staff push buyers too hard.

Final questions

6
questions for each pupil

150
Level 2 Business questions

2
of them on motivating and retaining employees

The game draws 6 of the 150 Level 2 questions; these 2 are about motivating and retaining employees.

1 Which action is a non-financial method of motivating employees?
Giving technicians more responsibility and recognition for good work.

2 A valeting firm pays workers for each vehicle completed. What is a possible disadvantage?
Workers may rush, reducing service quality.